

Shape the ground. The world grows. Count what bloomed.

The only builder where you place nothing — you shape the ground, and a living world grows itself.

The core loop (one Year)

1 • Shape

12 Moons. Each Moon: **act** (Uplift, Subduct, rain, seed — costs mana) or **rest** (free). Either way the world runs 12 ticks: water walks, soil moves, life spreads.

2 • Harvest

Count what stands. **Bloom = living hexes × (1 + Wonders)**. Wonders are shapes the water made: a Lake, a River, a Waterfall, an Island, a Ring of Life.

3 • The bar

Bloom ≥ this Year's target → continue. Below it → **the pot rests**: the run ends on the Behold screen. That is the only fail.

4 • Spring

Surplus Bloom becomes **Dew**. Shop: 3 Boons (permanent rule changes) + 2 Seed cards (kinds of life). Same pot, next Year, higher bar.

Eight Years in one pot. Year 1 is a puddle and a patch of moss; Year 8 is a world — or the pot rests earlier, and you behold what you grew.

Moment to moment

- **Read** the pot: where would water go, where is soil gathering, where can life reach.
- **Spend a Moon**: dig a basin (1 mana), raise a ridge (2), hang a cloud (3), sow a seed (1), or rest (0).
- **Watch** 12 ticks: the basin fills, the shore greens one hex a tick, the slag fan grows.
- **Plan** the next Moon from what you saw. Nothing moves while you think; nothing is random.

What you win by

- **Count**: living hexes. Life needs a course of soil, not drowned, and visible water beside it (a lake tile or a river).
- **Shape**: Wonders multiply the count. They are about water and terrain, so "cover everything in moss" never wins.
- **Build**: Boons + seeds + the shape you carved agreeing — Lake, River, Highland, Sprawl.

The numbers (first guesses, tune by play)

THING	VALUE
Moon	12 ticks
Year	12 Moons
Run	8 Years, ~40 min
Mana / Year	10, no carry-over
Action cost	brush ×1..×4 · depth ×1..×3
Cloud	3 per rain tile
Seed	1 + a card
Target Bloom	8 · 15 · 25 · 40 · 60 · 90 · 130 · 180
Dew at Harvest	2 + surplus÷5, cap 10, +interest
Boons held	max 5 · 4–8 Dew each

Cozy mode

Same game, no bar, no clock, 20 mana that carries, the shop as a menu, the Codex as a notebook. A mode — not the spine.

What your brief asked for, and where it landed

YOU ASKED	ANSWER
Sim-board roguelike	One pot, 8 Years, a rising bar, a gentle fail. Decided.
Free-shape + end-of-round score	Shaping stays free-form on any hex; Harvest counts the world as it stands. Decided.
Bloom = Σ living hex $\times$ synergy multipliers	Bloom = living hexes $\times$ (1 + sum of Wonder bonuses). Twelve Wonders listed with detectors. Decided; bonuses to tune.
Mana budget + rising threshold	10 mana a Year, cost = brush $\times$ depth; targets $\times 1.5$ a Year. Numbers flagged.
Spring shop / Boons / builds	3 Boons + 2 Seed cards per Spring, bought with Dew; 12 Boons listed; four builds fall out of them.
Cards	Cards are Seeds (Moss, Grass, Reed, Willow, Pine, Lotus), not shaping actions. This is the one interpretation I chose — veto it if you meant otherwise.
Cozy is a mode	Yes: pressure off, same world, ships in the demo.
Steam-first ~\$13, own art	Kept. Phase 0 beauty pass = palette + light + diorama camera + one post shader, no bought assets on hexes or water.
Life back on the water branch	Done and pushed: three rules, seed on the palette, measured.

Build order (stop and play after each)

#	STEP	PROVES	SIZE
1	Life	life reads from water and soil, no aura	done
2	Phase 0 beauty pass	the look is ours	1 day
3	Harvest: Bloom + Wonders on the bench	is beating your own Bloom fun? — go / no-go	2 days
4	Moons, Years, mana, the bar	the loop has tension	2 days
5	Seed cards: Moss, Grass, Reed	"what to sow" is a decision	1 day
6	Spring shop + 6 Boons	builds emerge	2 days
7	Seeded starting pots	variety without randomness in play	1 day
8	Behold + cozy mode + Codex	the felt moment	2 days
9	Rest of the roster	—	3 days
10	Vertical slice → demo → Next Fest	—	1 week

Five things only you can answer

- **Cards = seeds?** Or did you mean a hand of shaping cards? (Changes step 5.)
- **One pot for eight Years**, or a new pot each Year like Islanders?
- **Count Bloom as it stands** at the last Moon, or after a free settle? (Recommendation: as it stands.)
- **12 ticks a Moon** — decide by playing step 4.
- **Radius 12 or 14** for a run.

Full document: design/game-design-v0.1.pdf (29 pages, one chapter per page — the same content, with every rule, every Wonder, every Boon and the reasoning). This sheet is the part to argue about.